Freshers Welcome Session IPCG (Fri 2nd October 2026):

⚠️ 18:15–18:25 | Welcome — Arrive, Grab a Seat & Meet People

Location: Senior Common Room, South Kensington Imperial Campus
Gospel and Academia Project (GAP)'s guidance on running postgraduate events stresses a **relaxed, friendly atmosphere** and reducing barriers to attendance.

⚠️ 18:25–18:30 | Open in Prayer

Beginning with prayer and seeking God's heart for the campus and for the group.

⚠️ 18:30–18:45 | Introduction to ICPG

Vision for the group and the IFES/GAP vision statement is a great starting point: *"Jesus Christ is good news for the university: both for its scholars and for their research."* ICPG vision centres around the **three foundations** GAP articulates:

1. **Common mission** — how the gospel shapes our research, and how our research helps us point to the gospel
2. **Common beliefs** — rooted in Scripture
3. **Common ethos** — Scripture as "true truth" for all academic fields

Introduce **Term 1 calendar** and affiliated organisations: IFES, Forming a Christian Mind, Fruitful Work

---

⚠️ 18:45–19:15 | Personal Testimonies

This is the heart of the session. Discuss personal testimonies about how members came to know Christ. This will lead into thinking Biblically about our academic studies and how this links to our faith.

⚠️ 19:15–19:25 | How our Fields Point to Christ & Vice-Versa

GAP's article *"Thinking Christianly in Academia"* provides excellent framing for testimonies — encouraging Christians to speak about how their **faith enriches their academic thinking** rather than conflicting with it.

Discussion Questions:

- 🔬 *What is your field and research?*
- ✝️ *How does your faith relate to your academic work?*
- 🌱 *What has God been teaching you through your studies?*

GAP's resource *"Connecting with International Postgraduate Students"* offers practical tips here, which is particularly relevant at Imperial given its diverse international community[1]

Resources/Future Events

- The **GAP group study guides** (e.g. *"University of Daniel"* — a 12-part study for postgrads).
- The **Forming a Christian Mind** London Seminars (next one: Wed 7 October at UCL).
- The **Fellows Programme**, a 22-week intensive programme for PhD student leaders).

⚠️ 19:25–19:30 | Prayer and Close
Close with a short prayer and take prayer points.

📚 Key GAP Resources to Have Ready

Resource	Where to Find It
7 Distinctions for Relating the Gospel to Academic Work (8-part study guide)	gospelandacademia.org
Thinking Christianly in Academia	uccf.org.uk/research/resources
Forming a Christian Mind London Seminars	formingachristianmind.org
Fruitful Work (All-In Careers for Jesus)	fruitfulwork.org